

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE INDIA EQUITIES THESIS

Growth That Arrives Diluted

India's economy is doing almost everything the bulls asked of it. Real GDP grew 7.8% in the June quarter, above the central bank's own 7% projection. Bank credit is running near 19%. Household savings are entering the equity market at a record rate. And the Nifty 50 closed on 22 September at 23,329, roughly a tenth below where it began the year. The question has changed from whether the growth is real to why so little of it reaches the shareholder.

A reframe worth holding onto

The internal research view, most fully stated by Christopher Wood of Jefferies in the 17 September *Greed & Fear*, is that the Indian index is not lagging because the economy is weak but because the domestic bid is being absorbed by new paper. Monthly mutual fund inflows of roughly Rs388bn are met by equity issuance that swung from US\$1.0bn in April to US\$9.5bn in August. On this reading the Nifty is not a verdict on India; it is the residual after supply. Treat it as a view, not a forecast.

METHOD — External figures in this edition are drawn from exchange data, company results releases, official statistics and contemporaneous reporting, each dated where it appears. Internal figures and judgements are drawn from the Heyokha research Wiki page *India Equities* (created 24 June 2026, last reviewed 18 September 2026) and are attributed to the named research provider. Where the two disagree, both are stated and the disagreement is left standing. No figure that could not be verified or attributed has been retained.

Consider a water utility in a town that is genuinely booming. Consumption rises nineteen per cent a year; the mains are being extended into new districts; by every measure of activity the business is thriving. Three things nonetheless sit between that growth and the owner's return. The utility buys wholesale water at a price rising faster than the tariff it is permitted to charge, so each additional litre earns a thinner spread. It funds the new mains by selling fresh shares to the townspeople, who buy them willingly, so the claim on the business is divided among more holders each year. And the wholesale price is set abroad, in a currency the town does not control. The town's water consumption is a triumph. The return per share is a different number entirely, and it is the second number that a stock exchange quotes. India in September 2026 is that utility: volume superb, spread compressing, share count rising, input price imported.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

Rs32,297cr

Record monthly systematic investment plan contributions in August, up 14% year on year, with contributing accounts passing 100 million for the first time. *AMFI industry data, August 2026.*

Rs23,676cr

Net foreign portfolio selling of Indian equities through the exchanges between 1 and 19 September, reversing two months of buying. *Exchange data reported 19 September 2026.*

3.26%

HDFC Bank's net interest margin in the June quarter, down from 3.38% in March and the lowest on the bank's record, against 16% loan growth. *Company results, 18 July 2026.*

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

A quarter in which the economy and the index moved in opposite directions

The June-quarter national accounts, published on 31 August, put real GDP growth at 7.8% year on year, against the Reserve Bank of India's 7% projection. Manufacturing grew 9.2% and services 10%; gross fixed capital formation rose 11.9% in real terms, which is the line that matters for anyone arguing that a private investment cycle has begun. Bank credit, the fastest-moving confirmation available, grew 18.60% in the year to 15 August on Reserve Bank data, taking total scheduled-bank credit to roughly Rs226 lakh crore.

Over the same months the market fell. The Nifty 50 closed at 23,329.00 on 22 September, down 85.30 points on the day, with the Sensex at 74,529.08. Over twelve months the index is down roughly 8%; its 52-week range runs from 22,182.55 to 26,373.20, so it sits nearer the floor of that band than the ceiling. This is not a market pricing a 7.8% economy.

Three things account for the gap, and they are separable. The first is the terms of trade. Brent traded at \$98.47 on 22 September, having crossed \$100 earlier in the month; the Indian crude basket has averaged \$113.90 a barrel in September against \$69.61 a year ago, and the April-to-August crude import bill rose 48.4% to \$74.8bn. India imports the great majority of its oil, so that is a direct transfer of national income abroad, and it arrives in the consumer price index — August inflation of 4.82% was the highest since December 2024 — and in the rupee, which has traded close to 96 to the dollar.

The second is the banking spread. Credit growth near 19% is not the same thing as bank earnings growth. Deposits have grown more slowly, around 14.7% year on year, and a large part of the funding gap has been filled by concessional foreign-currency non-resident deposits — some \$64.4bn mobilised by 21 August under the swap facility. Lending fast against slower and partly temporary funding compresses margin. HDFC Bank's June quarter is the clearest illustration: loans up 16%, net interest income up only 7%, net interest margin at a record-low 3.26%, and net profit up 5%. The third is supply, and it is the one the internal view treats as decisive.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

Money entering the equity market and money bidding up the equity market are not the same flow. In a market issuing Rs80,698 crore of new paper in nine months, a record domestic inflow can be fully absorbed at unchanged prices — the capitalisation rises, the index does not. *India's savers have been buying the market. They have not, in aggregate, been re-rating it.*

MECHANISM

Where a rupee of household saving actually goes

1 · The saver commits

A household starts or maintains a systematic investment plan. Industry SIP contributions reached a record Rs32,297 crore in August, with more than 100 million contributing accounts and equity funds taking net inflows for a 66th consecutive month.

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2 · The fund must deploy

Net inflows into active equity schemes were Rs29,329 crore in August, 19% above July. The manager has a mandate to stay invested; the money has to find securities within weeks, not years.

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3 · New paper meets it

Mainboard IPOs have raised Rs80,698 crore across 74 issues so far in 2026, of which Rs42,005 crore is offer-for-sale — existing owners selling down. September's pipeline is another Rs20,000–25,000 crore.

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4 · The index stands still

Aggregate market capitalisation rises because there are more listed shares. The price of the existing ones need not. The Nifty is down roughly 10% year to date on the internal count while inflows set records.

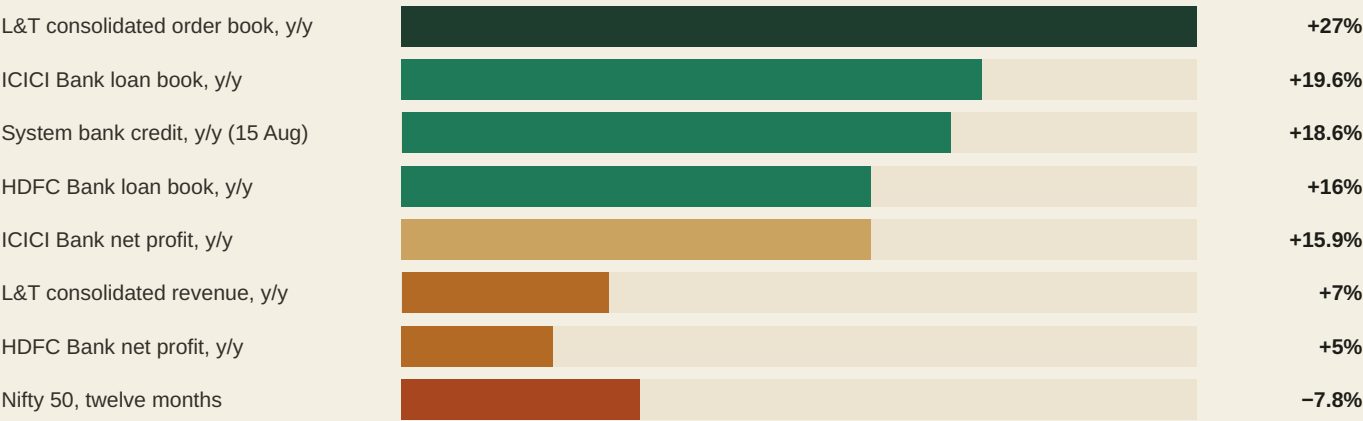
Sources: AMFI monthly industry data for August 2026; primary-market issuance totals and September pipeline as reported 4 and 20 September 2026; index level from exchange close, 22 September 2026. The year-to-date index decline of 10.9% is Jefferies' figure as at 17 September 2026 and is an internal citation, not an independently verified market print.



Sources: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation national accounts release, 31 August 2026; Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell crude basket pricing as reported 22 September 2026; National Stock Exchange closing level, 22 September 2026.

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

Activity grew. The claim on it grew less.



Bars are illustrative and scaled for comparison, not drawn to a common axis; the negative index bar is shown at absolute magnitude. Company figures are June-quarter FY27 results as released in July 2026; system credit is Reserve Bank fortnightly data to 15 August 2026; the index change is the twelve-month move to September 2026. The point of the chart is the spread between the top group and the bottom group, not the precise bar lengths.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

India runs a substantially closed capital account with an open domestic savings tap. That combination makes it the one large market where private owners can reliably sell at good prices — which is a genuine strength of the financial system, and simultaneously the mechanism that keeps the benchmark from rising. *The exit that works is paid for by the index that does not.*

WHAT HAS ACTUALLY SHIFTED

Four changes, each cutting both ways

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Credit has broadened beyond retail	System credit +18.60% y/y to 15 August. Jefferies reports corporate lending +21.6% and micro, small and medium enterprise lending +24.9% in July,	Corporate credit is the highest-beta part of a bank's book. It grows fastest into an upswing and provisions fastest out of one. A first corporate

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
	reading it as evidence the private capex cycle is finally turning.	credit acceleration is an early-cycle signal and an early-cycle risk at the same time.
Deposit growth no longer matches lending	Loans grew roughly 18.3% against deposits of about 14.7%, with \$64.4bn of concessional foreign-currency non-resident deposits mobilised by 21 August plugging part of the gap.	Cheap swap-window funding lets banks lend now, but it has a maturity and a price. It supports this year's volume and next year's margin question.
Energy has become a macro tax	Indian crude basket averaging \$113.90 in September against \$69.61 a year earlier; import bill +48.4% to \$74.8bn over April–August; CPI 4.82% in August, the highest since December 2024.	It is a real transfer of income abroad and a rate-policy constraint. It is also the most mean-reverting item on this list, and the one a ceasefire would reverse fastest.
Foreign money turned, then turned back	July saw a reported US\$2.5bn of foreign buying, the largest monthly inflow in 22 months. Between 1 and 19 September, foreigners sold a net Rs23,676 crore, with financial services the largest sector outflow at Rs6,204 crore in the first fortnight.	A single fortnight settles nothing. But it means the flow recovery that several internal notes treat as underway is, on the most recent evidence, not yet a trend.
The domestic bid became structural	Record SIP contributions of Rs32,297 crore in August, more than 100 million contributing accounts, a 66th consecutive month of positive net equity inflows, industry assets at a record Rs87.08 lakh crore.	It is the most durable support the market has and the reason valuations never fully capitulated. It is also what makes heavy issuance absorbable, which is precisely what caps the index.

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The growth is verified, not asserted.** June-quarter real GDP of 7.8% beat the central bank's own 7% projection, with real fixed investment up 11.9% — the component a capex-cycle thesis actually requires.
- **Valuation has already compressed.** 13D Research recorded the Nifty at roughly 17x forward FY27 earnings in June, the lowest multiple since the pandemic, arriving as earnings accelerate rather than as they roll over. Stated as that provider's view.
- **Banks are cheap against their own history.** CLSA's 18 September note puts Indian banks at 1.8x twelve-month forward price-to-book, a 20.6% discount to their sixteen-year average and the 3.2nd percentile of the distribution, against a 13.1% return on equity comparable to developed-market peers but a 12% two-year profit growth rate roughly two-thirds higher.
- **Not every bank is losing the spread.** ICICI Bank's June quarter showed net interest income up 12.7%, margin stable at 4.36%, loans up 19.6% and net profit up 15.9%, with gross non-performing assets improving to 1.38% from 1.67%. The margin squeeze is a franchise-level problem, not a systemic one.
- **Ownership is unusually light.** 13D notes India's MSCI Emerging Markets weight at 10.87%, down from roughly 21% in September 2024, with active emerging-market funds underweight against a decade-long history of being overweight — headroom that does not require new believers, only returning ones.
- **Supply is a timing problem, not a permanent one.** Issuance is running to beat a 30 September regulatory approval deadline. The overhang has an expiry date attached to it.

The bear case

- **The margin evidence contradicts the bank thesis directly.** HDFC Bank, the single largest weight in the banking complex, posted a record-low 3.26% margin and 5% profit growth on 16% loan growth. A valuation case built on "higher potential margins in an inflationary environment" is not yet visible in the largest private bank's results.
- **The funding mix is borrowed time.** Lending at 18.3% against 14.7% deposit growth, part-funded by \$64.4bn of concessional swap-window deposits, is a spread problem deferred rather than solved.
- **The flow premise failed within a day.** CLSA's bank call is explicitly conditioned on foreign inflows continuing. Exchange data show net foreign selling of Rs23,676 crore in the first nineteen days of September, with financial services the worst-hit sector.
- **Energy is a standing tax with a war attached.** A crude basket at \$113.90 against \$69.61, an import bill up 48.4%, inflation at a two-year high and the rupee near 96 are a combination that constrains the central bank precisely when growth would reward easing.
- **Operating leverage is going the wrong way in industrials too.** L&T's order book grew 27% while consolidated revenue grew 7% and profit 14%. Backlog is not cash, and the conversion gap is where a capex cycle either proves itself or does not.
- **The mid-cap premium is doing the work.** The part of the market Jefferies finds most interesting trades at 26.3x forward against the Nifty's 17.3x on its own figures, after a 95% run since the start of 2023. The cheap index and the preferred instrument are not the same asset.

How the bear case was built. The Wiki's "bear case & what breaks it" section is thin and dated: it runs to three short items — oil import vulnerability, foreign outflow momentum and reform fatigue — and its figures are largely from June. Of the six bear points above, four were constructed from external evidence published since: the September exchange flow data, the June-quarter bank and industrial results, and the crude basket and inflation prints. Two are tensions visible inside the internal sources themselves, read against each other. Readers should know that the bear case here is assembled, not quoted.

WHERE INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL PART COMPANY

An unresolved disagreement worth naming

The sharpest conflict is not between bulls and bears but between two bulls. Christopher Wood's 17 September note states the precondition plainly: for India to become a focus for emerging-market investors again, "the AI story has to blow up" — because Taiwan Semiconductor, Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix together account for 29% of the emerging-market index against India's 11%, and the money has to come from somewhere. CLSA's August framing is the mirror image: India is attractive precisely as a low-correlation hedge against the artificial-intelligence trade, something to own in case that trade breaks rather than something that requires it to break. One thesis needs a rupture to be rewarded; the other is sold as insurance against it. Both were published within a month, both are bullish, and they cannot both be the reason to own the asset.

The internal-versus-external split is narrower and more testable. CLSA's 18 September decision to add weight to Indian banks rests on a stated condition — that foreign inflows continue — and on an expectation of higher potential margins. Exchange data published the following day show foreigners selling Rs23,676 crore of Indian equities in September, with financial services the largest single sector outflow. HDFC Bank's most recent margin is a record low. Neither of these disproves a valuation argument built on sixteen-year percentiles; a fortnight of flows and one quarter of margin are short measures against that horizon. But the premise and the evidence are currently pointing in opposite directions, and this edition does not resolve which one gives way.

WHAT TO WATCH FROM HERE

The dashboard

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
RBI decision, 7 October	The Monetary Policy Committee meets 5–7 October with the repo rate at 5.25%, held for three consecutive meetings, and August inflation at 4.82%.	The single dated catalyst in the diary. A hike confirms energy has become the binding constraint; a hold says the committee is willing to look through an imported shock.
September-quarter bank margins	Whether HDFC Bank's 3.26% is a trough or a trend, and whether ICICI holds 4.36%.	This is the test of the internal bank thesis on its own terms. Volume growth is established; the spread is the open question.
October issuance after the deadline	Primary supply once the 30 September regulatory approval window closes.	If issuance falls sharply and the domestic bid holds, the absorption mechanism unwinds and the index can move without any change in earnings.
Foreign flow direction into October	Whether September's Rs23,676 crore of selling was a rebalancing month or the resumption of the year's pattern.	The flow argument is the one premise both internal houses share. It is also the one the exchanges publish daily.
Indian crude basket versus \$100	The basket has averaged \$113.90 in September; Brent was \$98.47 on 22 September.	It sets the current account, the currency, the inflation print and therefore the policy rate. It is the fastest-reversing variable on the page.
SIP contributions and redemptions	Record Rs32,297 crore of gross contributions in August — but gross equity mobilisation of Rs73,614 crore came against Rs44,285 crore of redemptions.	The net number is what absorbs supply. A rise in redemptions would remove the market's floor faster than any foreign flow.

THREE WAYS TO HOLD THE SAME VIEW

Three postures, not one answer

Own the spread, not the volume

Concentrate on franchises demonstrably converting loan growth into net interest income and profit, and accept paying more for them. The explicit cost: this abandons the deep-value argument entirely. The cheapest banks are cheap because the market doubts exactly this conversion, so the posture forgoes the re-rating that the sixteen-year percentile case is built on.

Own the index and wait out the supply

Treat the benchmark's underperformance as a mechanical artefact of issuance and hold it until the paper stops. The explicit cost: it is an unhedged bet on a timing variable nobody controls. Issuance responds to price, so a rally invites more supply, and the position pays nothing while waiting — with energy and the currency running against it throughout.

Own the plumbing, not the participants

Hold the exchanges, depositories and intermediaries that earn from issuance and turnover regardless of index direction. The explicit cost: it is a bet on activity that has already been repriced as a growth business, and it fails in the one scenario the other two postures survive — a market that is quiet, cheap and going up slowly on very little volume.

The companies named in this edition are illustrative of the mechanisms described. They are NOT recommendations, and nothing here is advice to buy, sell or hold any security.

HDFCB IN

HDFC Bank

NIM 3.26%
Q1 FY27, 18 Jul 2026

The clearest external illustration of the edition's argument. June-quarter loans grew 16% and net interest income 7%; net profit rose 5% to Rs19,060 crore; margin fell to 3.26% from 3.38% in March, the lowest on the bank's record. CLSA's 18 September note nonetheless makes it the worked example of the bank re-rating case, arguing that declining slippage ratios are overlooked by a market fixated on margin and loan-to-deposit ratio. The internal view and the reported margin are looking at the same bank and seeing different things.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the September quarter shows margin stabilising, which is the point at which volume growth starts reaching the bottom line.

ICICIB IN

ICICI Bank

NIM 4.36%
Q1 FY27, Jul 2026

The counter-example that keeps the thesis honest. Standalone net profit rose 15.9% to Rs14,805 crore on net interest income up 12.7%, with margin stable at 4.36% and loans up 19.6% to Rs16.31 lakh crore. Gross non-performing assets improved to 1.38% from 1.67% a year earlier. If the Indian banking spread were being compressed by a system-wide funding squeeze, this result would not look like this — which suggests the problem is distributed by franchise, deposit mix and pricing discipline rather than imposed uniformly.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the 4.36% margin survives a second quarter of funding competition and any October policy move.

LT IN

Larsen & Toubro

Order book +27%
Q1 FY27, Jul 2026

The capex cycle's scoreboard, and the same pattern in a different industry. The consolidated order book reached Rs778,954 crore at 30 June, up 27% year on year, on order inflows of Rs108,014 crore. Consolidated revenue grew 7% to Rs67,942 crore and net profit 14% to Rs4,123 crore. International work is now 51% of revenue and 52% of the book — which means a substantial part of what is read as an Indian investment cycle is being won abroad, chiefly in the Gulf.

WATCH NEXT

Revenue conversion against the backlog. A book growing four times faster than revenue is either a pipeline or a bottleneck.

ONGC IN

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation

Implied +69%
CLSA view, Aug 2026

The domestic hedge against the macro tax described above. CLSA rates it a high-conviction outperform with a Rs405 target and roughly 69% implied upside, arguing the shares discount around \$58 a barrel against an \$82 assumption for FY28, with gas volumes rising 7–8% before the end of 2026 and a 19.7% free cash flow yield. That is an internal broker view, stated as such. The external fact beside it is that the Indian crude basket averaged \$113.90 in September — the same price that hurts the country helps the producer.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the four new gas fields ramp on schedule, which is what separates the volume case from a pure oil-price proxy.

CDSL IN

Central Depository Services

130m+ accounts
Wiki, 11 Jun 2026

The elegant inversion of the argument. The issuance that absorbs the domestic bid and caps the index is, for the depository, revenue: 74 mainboard listings and Rs80,698 crore raised in nine months all pass through settlement infrastructure. 13D Research's internal India index names it the country's largest securities depository, with over 130 million investor accounts. Whoever is right about the Nifty, the paperwork gets done.

WATCH NEXT

October primary issuance once the 30 September deadline passes — this business's top line and the index's headwind.

GPL IN

Godrej Properties

ROE 20% FY28E
CLSA view, Aug 2026

The domestic demand read — the consumer side of this economy is not the problem. CLSA rates it outperform with a Rs2,600 target and roughly 28% upside, citing first-quarter pre-sales above estimates and retained FY27 guidance of Rs390bn; an internal broker view. The external corroboration sits in the Jefferies note: residential area sold across the top seven cities rose 7% in the first seven months of 2026 against a 1% decline in 2025.

WATCH NEXT

Whether pre-sales guidance survives a rate rise in October. Property is the most rate-sensitive expression of this theme.

The bottom line

What was repriced this year was not India's growth. The growth showed up: 7.8% in the June quarter, credit near 19%, fixed investment up 11.9% in real terms, household savings entering the market at a record rate. What was repriced was the shareholder's share of that growth — taken by an imported energy bill that rose 48.4%, by a banking spread compressing at the largest private lender, and by a primary market that issued Rs80,698 crore of new paper into a bid that was strong enough to absorb it all at flat prices.

The evidence is genuinely mixed, and the honest summary is that the internal case has the better of the long argument and the external data have the better of the recent one. Valuations really are at the low end of a sixteen-year range, ownership really is light, and the operating economy really is accelerating. But the specific instrument call now attracting the most internal conviction — Indian banks — rests on a flow premise that September contradicted and a margin premise that the June quarter did not support. The reasonable inference is that this is an early-cycle setup being priced as though it were a mid-cycle one, and that the gap closes through earnings rather than through multiple. The next test is dated: the Monetary Policy Committee on 7 October, followed by September-quarter margins.

Editorial note. This document is educational commentary prepared for internal use at Heyokha Brothers. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation, and not an offer or solicitation in respect of any security. Companies named are illustrative of the mechanisms discussed and were selected to demonstrate both sides of the argument; their inclusion is not a view on their merit. External figures are attributed and dated, and reflect information available as at 23 September 2026; markets move and figures date quickly. Internal figures are drawn from the firm's research Wiki and represent the opinions of the named third-party research providers, labelled as views rather than forecasts and not independently verified except where an external source is cited alongside. Where internal and external evidence conflict, both are stated and the conflict is left unresolved rather than adjudicated. Nothing here should be read as a price target or a forecast.

Sources and update notes

Internal. The primary internal source is the Heyokha research Wiki page *India Equities* (type: theme; created 24 June 2026; last reviewed 18 September 2026; 3,858 words). Provider issues relied on: 13D Research WILTW of 11 June 2026, the first 13D India-dedicated article, source of the ~17x forward FY27 multiple, the 27.4% FY27 top-100 earnings estimate, the +67% private capex figure, the MSCI weight of 10.87% and the active-fund underweight of 0.4pp; *Greed & Fear* (Christopher Wood, Jefferies) of 17 September 2026, reporting from the Jefferies 5th India Forum in Delhi, source of the 19.1% credit growth, the 21.6% corporate and 24.9% MSME breakdowns, the Rs388bn monthly inflow and the US\$1.0bn-to-US\$9.5bn issuance swing, the 26.3x mid-cap versus 17.3x Nifty multiples, the -10.9% year-to-date index figure, the 29%-versus-11% emerging-market weight comparison and the "AI story has to blow up" formulation; CLSA *Bits & Pieces* of 18 September 2026, source of the bank valuation percentiles, the 1.8x forward price-to-book and 20.6% discount, the 13.1% return on equity and 12% two-year profit growth comparisons, and the HDFC Bank worked example; CLSA *Bits & Pieces* of 21 August 2026, source of the July foreign inflow of US\$2.5bn and the low-correlation "AI hedge" framing; CLSA India company notes of 18–20 and 28 August 2026 for the ONGC and Godrej Properties figures; *Greed & Fear* of 16 July and 6 August 2026 for the flow history; and HS Dent Forecast of 1 July 2026 for the demographic endorsement.

Limitation on the internal view. The Wiki page carries nine sources, of which five are *Greed & Fear* issues by Christopher Wood and two are CLSA *Bits & Pieces*. A single house, Jefferies, therefore supplies the majority of the page's evidence, and the second-largest contributor is a broker publishing a focus list of Indian stocks it rates outperform. 13D Research contributes one article, dated 11 June 2026, from which a large share of the page's headline statistics is drawn — including the 27.4% earnings figure, which is materially above the 17% next-year estimate the same page carries from Jefferies, and which this edition has not used as a verified number for that reason. No source on the page is bearish on India. The page has no dedicated sceptic, no sell-side bear and no macro provider arguing the opposite case; its "bear case" section is three short paragraphs, largely unchanged since June. Readers should treat the internal material as a well-documented bull file rather than a balanced one.

External sources. (1) National Stock Exchange closing levels, 22 September 2026: Nifty 50 at 23,329.00, down 85.30 points or 0.36%; Sensex at 74,529.08, down 329.91 points. (2) Nifty 50 52-week range of 22,182.55 to 26,373.20 and a twelve-month decline of 7.80%, index data as at September 2026. (3) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation national accounts, released 31 August 2026: Q1 FY27 real GDP growth of 7.8% year on year against the Reserve Bank's 7% projection, manufacturing 9.2%, services 10%, gross fixed capital formation 11.9%. (4) Reserve Bank of India fortnightly scheduled-bank data to 15 August 2026: total bank credit of approximately Rs226 lakh crore, up 18.60% year on year; loans up 18.3% to Rs220 trillion against deposits up 14.7% to Rs269.3 trillion; \$64.4bn of FCNR(B) deposits mobilised under the concessional swap facility to 21 August 2026. (5) Consumer price inflation of 4.82% in August 2026, up from 4.45% in July and the highest since December 2024; food and beverages 5.52%, transport 4.43%. (6) Reserve Bank repo rate of 5.25%, held at the 5 August 2026 meeting for a third consecutive meeting with a neutral stance; the next Monetary Policy Committee meeting is scheduled for 5–7 October 2026 with the decision announced on 7 October. (7) Association of Mutual Funds in India data for August 2026: record SIP contributions of

Rs32,297 crore, up 14% year on year and 1.1% month on month; contributing SIP accounts above 100 million; net active equity inflows of Rs29,329 crore against Rs24,697 crore in July, from gross mobilisation of Rs73,614 crore and redemptions of Rs44,285 crore; a 66th consecutive month of positive equity net inflows; industry assets under management at a record Rs87.08 lakh crore. (8) Primary market data as reported 4 and 20 September 2026: Rs80,698 crore raised across 74 mainboard IPOs so far in 2026, comprising Rs38,693 crore of fresh capital and Rs42,005 crore of offer-for-sale; a September pipeline of approximately 25 issues worth Rs20,000–25,000 crore ahead of a 30 September regulatory approval deadline; July issuance of Rs20,100 crore. (9) Exchange foreign portfolio investment data: net selling of Rs23,676 crore through 19 September 2026 and Rs20,974 crore through 18 September; financial services the largest sector outflow at Rs6,204 crore in the 1–15 September fortnight, ahead of automobiles at Rs2,670 crore, with healthcare a net recipient of Rs2,114 crore for a sixth consecutive fortnight. (10) HDFC Bank Q1 FY27 results, released 18 July 2026: net profit of Rs19,060 crore, up 5%; net interest income of Rs33,534 crore, up 7%; net interest margin of 3.26%, down from 3.38% in the March quarter and a record low; loan growth of 16%. (11) ICICI Bank Q1 FY27 results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026: standalone net profit of Rs14,805 crore, up 15.9%; net interest income of Rs24,384 crore, up 12.7%; net interest margin of 4.36%; total loans up 19.6% to Rs16.31 lakh crore; gross non-performing assets of 1.38% against 1.67% a year earlier and net non-performing assets of 0.35%. (12) Larsen & Toubro Q1 FY27 results: consolidated revenue of Rs67,942 crore, up 7%; net profit of Rs4,123 crore, up 14%; order inflows of Rs108,014 crore, up 14%; consolidated order book of Rs778,954 crore at 30 June 2026, up 27% year on year; international business at 51% of revenue and 52% of the order book. (13) Energy prices: Brent at \$98.47 on 22 September 2026, down 1.87% on the day, having crossed \$100 on 10 September; the Indian crude basket averaging \$113.90 a barrel in September 2026 against \$69.61 a year earlier; India's crude import bill up 48.4% year on year to \$74.8bn over April–August 2026. (14) USD/INR trading around 95.96 in mid-September 2026.

Editorial choices in this automated run. The archive folder was read directly rather than through the remote-device bridge, which was not required; all forty-plus prior editions were parsed successfully and a thirty-day cooldown set of twenty-two topics was built from filenames dated 24 August 2026 onward, so the cooldown check is complete rather than inferred. Entity scoring over the eighteen source summaries published since 2 September produced two leaders. Copper scored highest on raw points, carrying the headline of the 17 September 13D WILTW, and is formally outside the cooldown window — its most recent edition was 19 August, thirty-five days ago. It was nonetheless passed over: copper has been the subject of four editions since 3 August, and a fifth within seven weeks would be repetitive rather than informative. India Equities scored second and was selected. It is the hot signal on the freshest evidence — the headline subject of the 17 September *Greed & Fear* ("a resilient India"), the dominant entity set in the 18 September CLSA issue, and present in three of the four most recent source summaries — it has never been the subject of a Field Guide, and its Wiki page was reviewed five days ago. Other high scorers were skipped as on cooldown: gold (26 August), critical minerals and oil and gas (21 September), China equities (22 September) and AI capex (8 September). Gold miners scored comparably and is formally eligible, its last edition being 5 August, but was passed over as too close to the 26 August gold edition. Six ticker cards were required by the format; four are supported by externally verified company results and two — Central Depository Services and Godrej Properties — rest on internal Wiki material, which is labelled as such in the card text. No tool failures occurred. The Wiki listing call exceeded the token limit and was read by pattern extraction rather than in full, as the format intends.

Prepared 23 September 2026 · Heyokha Brothers Market Field Guide · Commentary, not investment advice.